

August 20, 2026

Aetna
Provider Resolution Team
P.O. Box 14020
Lexington, KY 40512

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Kimiko Dooley (MRN MUSC0934346), Claim MUSC-75E9-3

Patient	Kimiko Dooley (DOB 1996-11-07)
MRN	MUSC0934346
Member ID / Group	AET817569447 / GRP-96846
Claim number	MUSC-75E9-3
Date of service	2026-02-02
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	Z34.90 — Encounter for supervision of normal pregnancy, unspecified
Denied amount	\$494.63
Denial code	CARC 50 / RARC N115 — These are non-covered services because this is not deemed a 'medical necessity' by the payer.
Appeal deadline	2026-08-28

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this Level 1 reconsideration appeal on behalf of patient Kimiko Dooley (MRN: MUSC0934346, Member ID: AET817569447, Group: GRP-96846) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-75E9-3 for services rendered on February 2, 2026, at MUSC Health East Cooper Medical Center. Aetna denied the claim in full on March 1, 2026, citing CARC 50 ("These are non-covered services because this is not deemed a 'medical necessity' by the payer") and RARC N115 ("This decision was based on a Local Coverage Determination (LCD)"), with the accompanying remark that "Documentation submitted does not establish that the service was reasonable and necessary for the diagnosis reported." MUSC Health respectfully disagrees with this determination and requests full reversal and payment at the allowed amount of \$361.68.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Ms. Dooley is a 29-year-old female patient with an active normal pregnancy (Z34.90) who presented on February 2, 2026, for an established-patient outpatient visit with Amara J. Boone, NP (NPI 1203948576) at MUSC Health East Cooper Medical Center. The encounter was billed as CPT 99214, an office or outpatient visit for an established patient requiring moderate-complexity medical decision-making. A secondary diagnosis of J06.9 was also documented at the time of the visit. Ms. Dooley's obstetric history includes a prior pregnancy, and her medical record reflects a pattern of ongoing prenatal supervision consistent with the primary diagnosis reported. Her active conditions, including the current pregnancy, warranted the level of evaluation and management provided.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The denial of this claim on medical necessity grounds is not supported by established clinical standards. Prenatal supervision visits for a pregnant patient are universally recognized as medically necessary and are a cornerstone of evidence-based obstetric care. CPT 99214 is an appropriate code for an established-patient evaluation and management service involving moderate complexity, and its use in the context of an active pregnancy with a secondary acute or chronic condition is consistent with correct coding guidance under CPT and ICD-10 conventions.

Aetna's invocation of RARC N115, referencing a Local Coverage Determination, does not provide a sufficient basis for denial in this instance. LCD policies govern Medicare coverage determinations and are not directly applicable to commercial plan adjudication without explicit contractual incorporation. MUSC Health requests that Aetna identify with specificity the LCD or internal coverage policy upon which this denial was based, as the payer's remittance does not cite a specific determination applicable to this commercial plan or this clinical scenario.

Furthermore, the payer's assertion that documentation does not establish medical necessity is contradicted by the clinical record. Ms. Dooley is an actively pregnant established patient. A moderate-complexity evaluation and management visit for prenatal supervision, particularly in the presence of a secondary diagnosis, is inherently reasonable and necessary. The rendering provider, a licensed nurse practitioner operating within her scope of practice, appropriately documented and billed for the service provided.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Aetna reverse the denial of Claim MUSC-75E9-3 in its entirety and issue payment at the previously established allowed amount of \$361.68 for CPT 99214 rendered on February 2, 2026. We further request that Aetna provide, in its written response, the specific LCD or coverage policy provision upon which the denial was based, so that any further appeal may be appropriately addressed. All supporting clinical documentation is submitted herewith via Availity Disputes and Appeals in accordance with the appeal instructions provided on the remittance advice. Should this Level 1 reconsideration be denied, MUSC Health reserves all rights to pursue further appeal levels available under the plan and applicable law.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record